Stat 134: Concepts of Probability, Spring 2026

Instructor: Adam Lucas

Lectures: MWF 10-11 am Dwinelle 155

Email: alucas@berkeley.edu (If you contact me please send your email from your @berkeley.edu email address –-- don't contact me through Canvas)

Adam's OFFICE HOURS: M 11-2pm in the Student Learning Center Atrium

TEXT: *Probability* by Jim Pitman. Students can view and download the text online at **SpringerLink** (campus network access required). An affordable paperback copy may also be purchased through this link.

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Office hours of the GSIs are held in the Student Learning Center. Times will be posted on bCourses/pages

IMPORTANT: For all questions/concerns please directly contact GSI Chloe and CC Adam:

Chloe Shen cjshen@berkeley.edu AND CC

Adam Lucas alucas@berkeley.edu

Prerequisites: Please take the diagnostic test (due Friday Jan 23) Mastery of the material in Appendices 1-4 of the text, fluency with calculus (derivatives and integrals) in two variables, and – these are crucial – clear logical reasoning and strong problem-solving skills. A diagnostic test will be due Friday of the first week of class for EC. It will be graded to give you important feedback. An excellent resource for reviewing the prerequisites is Anderson's Introduction to Probability (Appendix A,B,C,D), available online through the library.

Class website: bCourses

Class attendance: Class attendance is worth up to 1 percent EC on a sliding scale (i.e. if you attend all lectures you get 1% EC and if attend 50% of lectures you get 0.5% EC etc.) It can make a big difference if you are close to the boundary of a higher grade. Attending lecture gives me the opportunity to know you better and for this reason I only write letters of recommendation for students that attend lecture regularly. For all questions regarding attendance please contact GSI Xu, Sumeng sumeng@berkeley.edu

Summary Class Video: To maximize student attendance and engagement we will not be course capturing Stat 134 this semester (i.e. there will be no full recording of class). I will however post a short summary video before every class recapping the main points of the lecture. This isn't meant as a substitute for attending lecture but can be very helpful if you need to miss class due to illness.

EdStem: There will be a student run EdStem site for this class. The top 10 student answers (i.e. students who respond to other student's questions) will get up to 0.25% extra credit added to their final grade total in b-courses after the curve.

Class Warmup: Class starts punctually at 10am with a warmup question shown on the screen. You are expected to try and solve this question before class starts. We will review the solution at 10:10. If you can't get to class by 10am the warmup is posted in the pre-lecture notes in bCourses/pages/pre-lecture the night before. This is an important part of class as it warms you up for the day's lecture.

Daily Homework:

- Daily assignments are posted bCourses after each class. They are due before the next class on **Gradescope** . **It is your responsibility to upload HW properly. Always double check that you submitted properly well before the deadline. You cannot resubmit after the deadline.**

- Papers will be graded on a 0/1 scale. Each assignment will consist of around 3 problems. A good attempt on **all** problems will receive the score of 1; anything else will get 0. Course readers will determine what constitutes a "good attempt." We will be looking for reasoning and detailed work shown – it is assumed that you will show work or provide reasoning whether or not the question asks for it. If you use ChatGPT or AI for help you must indicate everywhere on your HW where you used it. This is partly to make a note to yourself that you should go back after doing the HW and practice that you can do a similar problem on your own. We provide minimal practice and highly recommended problems that you can test yourself. Remember that for quiz and exams you will need to solve problems on your own.
- Your **six lowest** daily homework scores (out of 32 HW) will be dropped from the computation of the homework component of your final grade. If you add the class after the first or second week of class you must use your six HW drops.
- No late homework will be accepted and while you are encouraged to work with other people, you must write up your own solutions.

Daily work flow:

1. Download and preview pre-lecture notes before class.
2. Come to class punctually at 10am and do warmup question on classroom screen by 10:10am or do warmup question on pre-lecture notes before coming to class.
3. Participate in class
4. Do recommended reading and daily HW
5. Attend biweekly sections
6. Attend professor or GSI OHs in SLC as needed

Extra Credit:
Extra credit is assigned after the grade thresholds for the class are determined at the end of the semester.

1) Be a top 5 ED Discussion answerer. This is worth up to 0.25% percent EC.
2) Submit the diagnostic test to gradescope by the due date for 0.25 percent EC
3) Attend lecture. Worth up to 1% EC.

Section and Section Quizzes:
Section is an important part of class where students get practice working on problems related to the lecture and homework. There will be four section quizzes during the term on dates listed in the calendar below. You must take your quiz in the section in which you are enrolled. Students with DSP accommodations need to schedule time with DSP. Your lowest quiz score will be automatically dropped on bCourses at the end of the semester, including a zero if you must miss a quiz due to an emergency.

Quiz1: Wednesday February 11
Quiz2: Wednesday March 4
Quiz3: Monday April 13
Quiz4: Wednesday April 29

Exams:

- Midterm Monday March 16, class time
- Final: Tuesday May 12 3-6pm

Grading:
If you do well on the final exam it can clobber your midterm score. In particular your overall grade is calculated as:

The max of:

- 15% Homework, 20% Quizzes, 25% Midterm, 40% Final
- 15% Homework, 20% Quizzes, 65% Final

If you don't take the final exam you will not pass the class.

Letter grades will be based on a combination of absolute cutoffs and the distribution of overall scores. This class is graded on a curve so approximately 30% A, 30% B, 30% C in the class.

Stat 198 (class adjunct) and Topic Reviews. These are run by Mike Leong mleong@berkeley.edu. Stat 198 is a course for you to explore and practice strategies for learning Stat 134 material well. Topic Reviews are twice-weekly review sessions focused on solidifying your understanding of material covered in lecture about a week prior.

Stat Scholars The Stat Scholars Program https://statistics.berkeley.edu/academics/undergrad/program/stat-scholars provides a community of aspiring statistics majors and extra support in Stat 134. Applications are due in the second or third week of the semester. **Students selected to the Stat Scholars program are expected to attend at least 90% of lectures.**

Students with Disabilities: Students needing accommodations should speak with me after class or during office hours and see http://dsp.berkeley.edu to learn about Berkeley's policy.

Academic Honesty: Academic honesty is of particular concern. Please know that I take the Berkeley honor code very seriously and have years of experience catching cheaters. If we suspect someone of cheating, we reserve the right to give the student an oral quiz or exam and test if the student understands what they wrote.

Please familiarize yourself with UCBs Academic Honesty Policy (see the Center for

Student Conduct website: http://sa.berkeley.edu/conduct). I encourage you to discuss homework problems with other students and to work together, but copying is never appropriate. (You should never write down anything you don't understand!) I strongly encourage you to familiarize yourself with the definition of *plagiarism*, and to avoid engaging in it. **Violations of the USB's Academic Honesty Policy, including instances of plagiarism, will be reported to the University** and an appropriate penalty will be implemented. (This may range from a failing grade on an assignment to an "F" for the course, in addition to writing letters of reflection and apology to USB's administration.)